API Design Checklist

Viducate demo · Building REST APIs

Resources

- Use plural nouns: `/courses`, `/courses/{id}/videos`
- Let HTTP methods carry the verb: GET, POST, PUT/PATCH, DELETE
- Keep URLs stable; version in the path or a header

Responses

- `201 Created` with a Location header after POST
- `204 No Content` for successful deletes
- One error shape everywhere: `{ "error": { "code", "message" } }`

Collections

- Paginate with `limit` / `offset` or cursors
- Filter and sort with query parameters
- Return totals so clients can render pagers

Security

- Authenticate with short-lived tokens; authorise per resource
- Validate every input; rate-limit sensitive routes